

Ubuntu for Android is no longer under development, says Canonical

Due to other priorities, Canonical has shuttered the active development of Ubuntu for Android (U4A). The news regarding the shut down of the U4A project first came to light when a public bug report mentioned the same. This was followed by an official statement by Canonical explicitly quoting that U4A is indeed no longer under development.

"We still believe that U4A is a great product concept and that consumers would welcome the feature. The development within Ubuntu for U4A is complete. To take the development further requires a launch partner in order to make the necessary modifications on the Android side. We are currently not in concrete discussions with launch partners, but we are still very much open to such a partnership," Canonical's statement to Android Authority said. Canonical is now wholeheartedly focusing on its own smartphone OS, Ubuntu for Phones, which is why U4A has perhaps been given the axe. "We are focused on Ubuntu for Phones at the moment. Therefore, we are not actively pushing for U4A. However, if a prospective partner steps forward, we are very much open to launching Ubuntu for Android," Canonical added.



Here comes the humble Pi-Phone!

The humble Raspberry Pi board never ceases to amaze us. Programmer-photographer David Hunt has now gone ahead and turned the Pi board into a US\$ 160 cell phone. Besides, the developer has also expressed his desire to upload the source code for all to see and work with.

The working smartphone has the Raspberry Pi under the hood and is made of a bunch of off-the-shelf parts—an Adafruit PiTFT touchscreen, a SIM900 GSM/GPRS module and a 2,500 mAh battery. Hunt has also provided a video to demonstrate how the amazing device works.



In a related development, Raspberry Pi unveiled a new board that fits in the humble Pi's processor coupled with 4 GB of storage in the space of a tiny DDR2 memory stick. Pi's new compute module will allow circuit board developers to attach desirable interfaces into the small standard connector of the module. The compute module bids adieu to the tradition of using the built-in ports on a conventional Pi design. The module will come along with a starter IO board and is expected to be launched in June this year. There's still no word about the pricing, though folks at Raspberry Pi have revealed that large scale buyers like educators can buy the module in batches of 100 at a price of around US\$ 30 per piece.

Torvalds honoured with a prestigious award

Linux founder, Linus Torvalds, has been awarded the prestigious 2014 IEEE Computer Society's 'Computer Pioneer Award' for spearheading the development of the famed Linux kernel using the humble open source approach. First established in 1981, the Computer Pioneer Award is presented to outstanding individuals whose main contribution to the concepts and development of the computer industry spans at least 15 years or more.

Torvalds has been the recipient of a number of highly prestigious awards—the EFF Pioneer Award, and the Lovelace Medal from the British Computer Society, among others. He is also an honourable inductee into the Internet Hall of Fame.

The world's largest social network for cricket, CricHQ, comes to India

The social network for cricket, CricHQ, was made available to Indian users on May 3, 2014. The Indian launch of the app was timed to coincide with the beginning of a programme called 'Meet Your Heroes', which gives Indian cricket fans a chance to meet cricketers from various countries. The programme is open to users who register on CricHQ to create their own profile.

In addition, CricHQ also has a partnership with Nokia (Microsoft), which has made the app available on the Nokia X and Lumia platforms. The 'Meet Your Heroes' programme, though, is available to all fans registering on the social network, either on their website, the mobile site or the app.

The CricHQ social network not only allows fans to create their profiles and enjoy cricket related features, but also hosts cricketers. This gives fans the unique opportunity to follow cricketers' lives by adding them on the network. According to Simon Baker, CEO, CricHQ, "Up until now, it (CricHQ) has mostly been for the administrators; but now with the social media stuff, there's more for the fans."